



वस्त्र मंत्रालय
MINISTRY OF
TEXTILES

सत्यमेव जयते



Round 1 Briefing

July 2026



4 Stages of HH 2025



Round 1 Process & Key Dates



Round 1 : Idea Submission

4th July - 20th July 2026 by 11:59 pm

Round 2: Selection

Technical screening of all ideas submitted

July 21st - July 25th 2026

Round 3 - Finalist Prep

Virtual mentoring sessions for all 25 finalists (theme-wise)

July 26th - July 31st 2026

Round 4 - Grand Finale

August 1st 2026

HACKATHON THEMES AND PROBLEM STATEMENTS



HH2026 expands to four themes with pre-identified problem statements:

Theme	Problem Statements
Theme 1: Innovation in Design & Operations	Smart Production tracking · Process modernisation in the Weaving / Pre-weaving processes · Adapting Traditional Designs for Global Markets · Ergonomic Loom solutions for reducing drudgery of handloom Weavers.
Theme 2: Market Access & Digital Integration	Rural Weaver-to-Digital Market Platform · Digital Authenticity & Weaver Stories (QR/Blockchain) · B2B Digital Marketplace for Bulk Orders · Digital Storytelling for Global Brand Building
Theme 3: Sustainability & Environmental Impact	Eco-Friendly Natural Dyeing Solutions · Water Conservation in Handloom Production · Circular Economy for Handloom Waste · Renewable Energy for Handloom Units
Theme 4 (NEW): Weaver Livelihoods & Financial Inclusion	Fintech & Micro-credit Access for Weavers · Income Stability & Demand Forecasting Tools · Cooperative Digitisation & Collective Bargaining Platforms



Theme 1: Innovation in Design and Handloom Operations



Theme 1: Innovation in Design and Handloom Operations

Problem Statement 1.1: Smart Production Tracking for Weavers

The Challenge

Handloom weavers and weaving clusters often rely on manual methods to track production, manage orders, and monitor raw material usage. This lack of visibility leads to inefficiencies, delayed deliveries, material wastage, and limited ability to plan production effectively..

Your HH Mission

Develop a simple and affordable solution that enables weavers and producer groups to digitally track production activities, manage inventory, monitor work progress, and improve planning. The solution should help increase productivity, reduce waste, and support better decision-making at the individual and cluster level.



Theme 1: Innovation in Design and Handloom Operations

Problem Statement 1.2: Process Modernisation in Weaving & Pre-Weaving Operations

The Challenge

Many weaving and pre-weaving processes such as warping, winding, sizing, dyeing, and loom preparation continue to be highly manual, time-consuming, and prone to inconsistencies. These challenges reduce productivity and limit the ability of weavers to meet growing market demands.

Your HH Mission

Create innovative tools, technologies, or process improvements that modernize weaving and pre-weaving operations while preserving traditional craftsmanship. The solution should improve efficiency, consistency, quality, and ease of operation for handloom weavers and clusters



Theme 1: Innovation in Design and Handloom Operations

Problem Statement 1.3: Adapting Traditional Designs for Global Markets

The Challenge

India's handloom heritage is rich in traditional motifs, patterns, and weaving techniques. However, many of these designs struggle to align with changing consumer preferences and global market trends, limiting their commercial potential and reach.

Your HH Mission

Design solutions that help weavers, artisans, and designers adapt traditional handloom designs for contemporary domestic and international markets. The solution should enable innovation in design while preserving cultural authenticity, helping handloom products appeal to a wider global audience.



Theme 1: Innovation in Design and Handloom Operations

Problem Statement 1.4: Ergonomic Loom Solutions for Reducing Drudgery of Handloom Weavers

The Challenge

Handloom weaving often involves repetitive movements, prolonged sitting, and physically demanding tasks that can lead to fatigue, musculoskeletal disorders, and reduced productivity. These challenges affect the health and well-being of weavers and discourage younger generations from entering the profession

Your HH Mission

Develop affordable ergonomic solutions, loom enhancements, or assistive technologies that reduce physical strain and improve comfort for handloom weavers. The solution should enhance productivity, promote occupational well-being, and support the long-term sustainability of the weaving profession



Theme 2: Market Access and Digital Integration



Theme 2: Market Access and Digital Integration

Problem Statement 2.1: Connecting Rural Weavers to Digital Markets

The Challenge

Talented weavers in remote Indian villages lack direct access to urban and international customers, forcing them to sell through multiple intermediaries who capture most of the profit margin..

Your HH Mission

Create a user-friendly, multilingual, low-bandwidth digital platform that enables individual handloom weavers in remote areas to directly showcase their products, set their own prices, and sell to customers across India and globally, bypassing traditional middlemen.



Theme 2: Market Access and Digital Integration

Problem Statement 2.2: Digital Authenticity and Weaver Stories

The Challenge

Consumers struggle to distinguish genuine handloom products from machine-made imitations, while weavers' personal stories and craftsmanship heritage remain invisible to end customers, reducing the premium value of authentic handloom products.

Your HH Mission

Develop a reliable, easy-to-verify digital system (using QR codes, blockchain, or other technologies) that allows customers to trace a product's journey from loom to market, learn about the weaver's story, and confidently verify its authenticity



Theme 2: Market Access and Digital Integration

Problem Statement 2.3: Digital B2B Marketplace for Bulk Orders

The Challenge

Handloom weavers and producer groups struggle to connect with bulk buyers, fashion designers, and export houses, missing out on large-order opportunities that could provide stable income and business growth.

Your HH Mission

Design a digital marketplace or networking platform that seamlessly connects handloom producers with bulk buyers, facilitating easy discovery, communication, order management, and transaction processing for B2B handloom trade.



Theme 2: Market Access and Digital Integration

Problem Statement 2.4: Digital Storytelling for Global Brand Building

The Challenge

The rich cultural significance, intricate craftsmanship, and human stories behind Indian handloom products are poorly communicated to global audiences, limiting their perceived value and market appeal

Your HH Mission

Create engaging digital content strategies and formats (short videos, interactive experiences, virtual tours) that effectively tell the compelling stories of Indian handloom traditions, weavers, and craftsmanship to build emotional connections with global consumers.



Theme 3: Sustainability and Environmental Impact



Theme 3: Sustainability and Environmental Impact

Problem Statement 3.1: Eco-Friendly Natural Dyeing Solutions

The Challenge

Synthetic dyes used in handloom production are expensive, environmentally harmful, and often produce inconsistent colors, while natural dye alternatives are difficult to source, prepare, and standardize at scale.

Your HH Mission

Develop cost-effective, scalable natural dyeing solutions using locally available materials (vegetables, plants, minerals) that can deliver consistent, vibrant colors while being environmentally friendly and economically viable for widespread adoption by handloom clusters.



Theme 3: Sustainability and Environmental Impact

Problem Statement 3.2: Water Conservation in Handloom Production

The Challenge

Handloom production, especially yarn dyeing and fabric finishing processes, consumes large amounts of water, creating both environmental concerns and operational costs for weavers in water-scarce regions.

Your HH Mission

Design innovative water conservation techniques or systems that can significantly reduce water consumption in handloom processes, particularly dyeing and finishing, while maintaining product quality and being affordable for small-scale handloom units.



Theme 3: Sustainability and Environmental Impact

Problem Statement 3.3: Circular Economy for Handloom Waste

The Challenge

Handloom production generates significant fabric waste, yarn scraps, and textile offcuts that are typically discarded, representing both lost economic value and environmental waste.

Your HH Mission

Propose viable business models or technologies for collecting, sorting, and transforming handloom waste materials into new valuable products, creating additional income streams for weavers while promoting circular economy principles..



Theme 3: Sustainability and Environmental Impact

Problem Statement 3.4: Sustainable Energy for Handloom Operations

The Challenge

Many handloom units rely on expensive grid electricity or diesel generators for lighting and auxiliary processes, increasing operational costs and carbon footprint, especially in areas with unreliable power supply.

Your HH Mission

Develop affordable renewable energy solutions specifically designed for handloom operations that can reduce energy costs, improve reliability, and minimize environmental impact while being practical for rural implementation



Theme 4 (New): Weaver Livelihoods & Financial Inclusion



Theme 4: Weaver Livelihoods & Financial Inclusion

Problem Statement 4.1: Fintech & Micro-credit Access for Weavers

The Challenge

Many handloom weavers, especially those in rural and unorganized sectors, lack access to formal banking, affordable credit, and financial services. They often depend on informal lenders who charge high interest rates, limiting their ability to invest in raw materials, upgrade equipment, or expand their businesses.

Your HH Mission

Develop inclusive fintech solutions that enable weavers to access affordable micro-credit, digital payments, savings, insurance, and financial literacy services. Your solution should be simple, trustworthy, and accessible to rural communities, helping weavers build financial resilience and grow their livelihoods



Theme 4: Weaver Livelihoods & Financial Inclusion

Problem Statement 4.2: Income Stability & Demand Forecasting Tools

The Challenge

Handloom weavers frequently face irregular income due to seasonal demand fluctuations, uncertain market trends, delayed payments, and lack of visibility into future orders. This income instability affects their financial security and discourages younger generations from pursuing weaving as a livelihood.

Your HH Mission

Create intelligent tools that help weavers anticipate market demand, forecast orders, plan production cycles, and manage income more effectively. The solution should provide actionable insights using local market data, buyer trends, and historical demand patterns to support stable earnings and better business decisions.



Theme 4: Weaver Livelihoods & Financial Inclusion

Problem Statement 4.3: Cooperative Digitisation & Collective Bargaining Platforms

The Challenge

Many weaving cooperatives and producer groups continue to rely on manual processes for member management, procurement, sales, and communication. Limited digital adoption reduces operational efficiency and weakens their ability to negotiate better prices, access larger markets, and collectively advocate for their interests.

Your HH Mission

Design a digital platform that empowers weaving cooperatives and producer groups to manage operations efficiently, connect members seamlessly, and strengthen collective bargaining power. The solution should support collaboration, transparent record-keeping, bulk procurement, market linkages, and data-driven decision-making to improve the economic well-being of weaver communities.

Idea Submission Link

(Last date to submit - 20th July 2026 11:59 pm)



<https://youthideathon.in/handloom/>